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A **STUDY GUIDE** BY ANNE CHESHER & EMILY DAWSON



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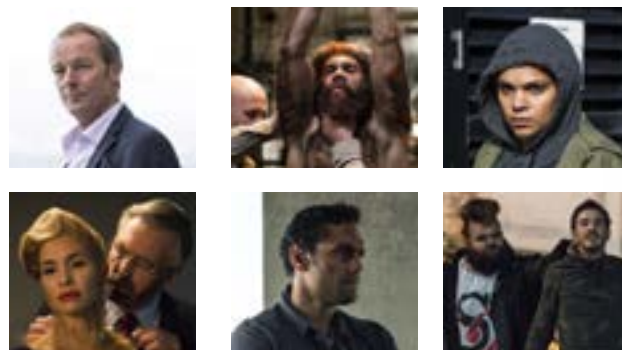
CLEVERMAN is a six one-hour episode television drama series that asks what would happen if creatures from the ancient mythological spirit world co-existed among us in the general population in what we take to be “the real world”.

Caution: Please note that the CLEVERMAN series contains occasional explicit material and language that some people may find offensive. It is therefore recommended that teachers and parents view the series before showing it to students in order to be informed and prepared to provide guidance to students.

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INSPIRATION

A Cleverman is an important being for many Australian Indigenous cultures. They are often a man of power within the clan. They are the conduit between the Dreaming and this world. There are many types of Cleverman, and each Aboriginal Country's Cleverman plays a different role. These men inspired the production of the CLEVERMAN series.

CONCEPTUALISATION

The idea for CLEVERMAN came to Ryan Griffen while dressing up as Ninja Turtles with his young son. As a young Aboriginal person, it was important for Ryan that his son had an entertaining cultural superhero he could look up to. "I got thinking about creating something cultural - something Aboriginal, Indigenous - that he could connect to on a superhero basis," Ryan says.

Ryan conceived a 'world' set in the near future, where a species from ancient mythology known as *Hairypeople*, must live amongst humans and battle for survival in a society that wants to silence, exploit and destroy them.

Ryan Griffen visited Indigenous communities around Australia with an Indigenous advisor to seek permission to tell Dreaming stories. "One of the stories that we obtained permission to tell was from out near Katherine in the Northern Territory. I sat in a riverbed with an elder where there's a songline - paths across the land, water or sky which mark the route followed by spirits or 'creator-beings' during the Dreaming. It was an absolute privilege to be there to hear the story and then for the community to give me the permission to bring it to the screen."

Indigenous protocols were strictly adhered to throughout the production process.

CLEVERMAN THEMES

CLEVERMAN addresses several themes on contemporary society issues that, according to ACARA's cross-curricula priority and as a general capability of intercultural understanding, are curriculum relevant for students from Years 9 to 12. These include:

- Power
- Identity
- Media Influence
- Kinship, family and belonging
- Indigenous spirituality
- Multiculturalism
- People smuggling
- Walled communities
- Minority groups
- Slavery
- Ethics
- Scientific innovation



CURRICULUM

CLEVERMAN is relevant to the teaching and learning of the Australian Curriculum on several levels:

- As a national cross-curriculum priority,
- As a general capability learning outcome,
- English (Years 9-12),
- The Arts (Years 9-12).

» CROSS-CURRICULUM PRIORITY

The Australian Curriculum Reporting and Assessment Authority (ACARA) purports three cross-curriculum priorities for teaching and learning across all subject areas in Australian schools. The first cross-curriculum priority is *Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander histories and cultures* thereby providing opportunity for all young Australians to 'gain a deeper understanding and appreciation of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander histories and cultures, deep knowledge traditions and holistic world views'.

The objective of the priority is that all learners will develop knowledge and understanding to 'participate positively in the ongoing development of Australia through a deepening knowledge and connection with the world's oldest continuous living cultures'.

CLEVERMAN supports this learning by providing opportunity for students to gain a deeper understanding of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' ways of being, knowing, thinking and doing.

CLEVERMAN aligns directly to the priority's conceptual focus on Country/Place, Peoples and Cultures and as such is the ideal resource for setting up a coherent learning framework which includes developing knowledge and understanding of the:

- The unique belief systems that connect people physically and spiritually to Country/Place,
- The diversity of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' culture through language, ways of life and experiences as expressed through historical, social and political lenses.

» GENERAL CAPABILITIES

ACARA recommends that by the end of Year 10 (Level 6) students should have the general capability Intercultural Understanding skills to:

- **Investigate culture and cultural identity** through analyse how membership of local, regional, national and international groups shapes identities including their own
- **Explore and compare cultural knowledge, beliefs and practices** to be able to critically analyse the complex and dynamic nature of knowledge, beliefs and

practices in a wide range of contexts over time

- **Develop respect for cultural diversity** through understanding the importance of mutual respect in promoting cultural exchange and collaboration in an interconnected world
- **Communicate across cultures** so as to analyse the complex relationship between language, thought and context to understand and enhance communication
- **Consider and develop multiple perspectives** that present a balanced view on issues where conflicting views cannot easily be resolved
- **Empathise with others** in order to recognise the effect that empathising with others has on their own feelings, motivations and actions
- **Reflect on intercultural experiences** to reflect critically on the effect of intercultural experiences on their own attitudes and beliefs and those of others
- **Challenge stereotypes and prejudices** to critique the use of stereotypes and prejudices in texts and issues concerning specific cultural groups at national, regional and global levels
- **Mediate cultural differences** so as to recognise the challenges and benefits of living and working in a culturally diverse society and the role that cultural mediation plays in learning to live together

(Source: http://www.acara.edu.au/verve/_resources/General_capabilities_-_ICU_-_learning_continuum.pdf)

» ENGLISH

In the 21st century classroom the study of English has expanded to enable students to develop literacy and language mastery and appreciation across all platforms from traditional texts to innovative communication technologies. CLEVERMAN provides the opportunity as a text that reveals 'the imaginative potential of the language, including how that relates to cinema, television, and multimedia'. With CLEVERMAN senior students can critically analyse how texts manipulate themes, ideas, and historical and cultural contexts.

CLEVERMAN match points for Year 10 as foundation for English in Years 11 and 12:

1. Acknowledgement of the influence of text in shaping our personal, cultural and national identities
2. Understanding of how text has purpose and can exert influence to position the audience
3. Appreciation of texts influence all aspects of the human experience and their aesthetic values
4. Diversity of language and texts in structure and usage depending on cultural and social context
5. Manipulating language according to audience and purpose
6. Understanding of human experiences and the capacity for language to communicate those experiences
7. Analysis of different interpretations of texts and how to use language to achieve specific effects
8. Refining language, literature and literacy skills which

enable students to interact confidently and effectively with others in everyday, community, social and applied learning contexts

» CONTENT DESCRIPTIONS EXAMPLES

Language for interaction - Understand how language use can have inclusive and exclusive social effects, and can empower or disempower people (ACELA1564)

Expressing and developing ideas - Evaluate the impact on audiences of different choices in the representation of still and moving images (ACELA1572)

Responding to literature - Analyse and explain how text structures, language features and visual features of texts and the context in which texts are experienced may influence audience response (ACELT1641)

Responding to literature - Evaluate the social, moral and ethical positions represented in texts (ACELT1812)

Examining literature - Identify, explain and discuss how narrative viewpoint, structure, characterisation and devices including analogy and satire shape different interpretations and responses to a text (ACELT1642)

Texts in context - Analyse and evaluate how people, cultures, places, events, objects and concepts are represented in texts, including media texts, through language, structural and/or visual choices (ACELY1749)

Interpreting, analysing, evaluating - Identify and analyse implicit or explicit values, beliefs and assumptions in texts and how these are influenced by purposes and likely audiences (ACELY1752)

Creating texts - Create sustained texts, including texts that combine specific digital or media content, for imaginative, informative, or persuasive purposes that reflect upon challenging and complex issues (ACELY1756)

(Source: <http://www.australiancurriculum.edu.au/seniorsecondary/english/english/curriculum/seniorsecondary#page=1>)

» THE ARTS

At senior secondary level, students undertaking the Media Arts strand of The Arts curriculum analyse social and cultural values and evaluate 'how genre and media conventions and technical and symbolic elements are manipulated to make representations and meaning'. Through developing knowledge and understanding students interpret symbolic elements and media conventions to appreciate how social, institutional and ethical issues influence the making and use of media artworks.

CLEVERMAN match points for Media Arts students in Years 9 and 10:

1. Refine and extend their understanding and use of structure, intent, character, settings, points of view, genre conventions and media conventions in their compositions
2. Analyse the way in which audiences make meaning and how audiences interact with and share media artworks
3. Draw on media arts from a range of cultures, times and locations as they experience media arts
4. Explore the media arts and influences of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples and of the Asia region
5. Learn that Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people have converted oral records to other technologies
6. Explore the representation of relationships that have developed between Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples and other cultures in Australia and how these may influence their own artistic intentions in making media artworks
7. Explore meaning and interpretation, forms and elements, and social, cultural and historical influences of media arts as they make and respond to media artworks
8. Consider the local, global, social and cultural contexts that shape purpose and processes in production of media artworks

» CONTENT DESCRIPTIONS EXAMPLES

Experiment with ideas and stories that manipulate media conventions and genres to construct new and alternative points of view through images, sounds and text (ACAMAM073)

Manipulate media representations to identify and examine social and cultural values and beliefs, including those of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples (ACAMAM074)

Plan and design media artworks for a range of purposes that challenge the expectations of specific audiences by particular use of production processes (ACAMAM076)

Evaluate how technical and symbolic elements are manipulated in media artworks to create and challenge representations framed by media conventions, social beliefs and values for a range of audiences (ACAMAR078)

Analyse a range of media artworks from contemporary and past times to explore differing viewpoints and enrich their media arts making, starting with Australian media artworks, including media artworks of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples, and international media artworks (ACAMAR079)

(Source: http://www.australiancurriculum.edu.au/the-arts/curriculum/f-10?layout=1#page_ma)



PRODUCING CLEVERMAN

Producer Rosemary Blight of Goalpost Pictures Australia remembers Ryan Griffen's original pitch.

'I immediately could see how hugely challenging the series was going to be - marrying that 60,000 years of story telling with the contemporary medium of television, setting it in a kind of the near future, and a genre format.'

'There are no books, there's no text, there's no Aboriginal Shakespeare. So you have to listen. You've got to sit in rooms with people who have been handed the stories down from generation to generation to generation. So we spent a lot of time talking and listening and talking and listening so that the stories could bubble up.'

After around 6 years of development and research, CLEVERMAN pre-production officially began in February 2015 and ran until the end of April 2015. The production office was located at Callan Park in Sydney.

Directed by Wayne Blair (Episodes 1, 2, 5 & 6) and Leah Purcell (Episodes 3 & 4), the Season One shoot took a total of twelve weeks to complete. This was broken into three blocks of four weeks each. During each four-week block period, two consecutive episodes were shot. Cinematographer Mark Wareham shot all six of Season One's episodes.

The shoot locations were located in Sydney CBD and Sydney's outer suburbs so as to create the diverse world of CLEVERMAN. The enormous rail yards in Sydney's suburb of Eveleigh provided the unique and distinct look of The Zone. The scope of shooting in these yards allowed the creative team to build the story of The Zone to include inhabitants who seek refuge within its walls.

CLEVERMAN's post-production was conducted in Wellington, New Zealand and was completed at the beginning of 2016.

CLEVERMAN is an official Australian/New Zealand co-production between Goalpost Pictures Australia and Pukeko Pictures. The series was commissioned by the ABC TV Indigenous Department and produced in association with Screen Australia, Screen NSW, Sundance TV and Red Arrow International.

SERIES SYNOPSIS

In the very near future, creatures from ancient mythology have suddenly emerged and must coexist with humans. Known as Hairypeople for the matted hair covering their bodies, they have extraordinary strength, speed and longevity but are cast as social misfits and seek refuge in The Zone: a fragile community that finds strength in the brotherhood between Hairy and human.

When a series of violent, unexplained murders terrifies the city, blame for the bloodshed is pointed firmly in the direction of the Hairies. Raids mandated by the Containment Authority – a government-funded body established to capture runaway Hairypeople – threaten the already tenuous peace within The Zone. But other mythical creatures exist in this world, terrifying creatures like the Namorrodor that can rip a person's heart out.

There is one chosen being – the Cleverman – who has the power to bring these two worlds back together and sees exactly what evil truly lies behind the attacks.

Following the mysterious death of his uncle, Koen West becomes the new Cleverman – a young man in denial of his culture and estranged from his family – who is far from the model hero that the Hairies and people of The Zone so desperately need.

Koen's half-brother, Waruu, is his antithesis. A man of strong culture, Waruu battles tirelessly against the oppressive Containment Authority and his own demons. Believing himself to be the protector of his people and the natural heir to the Cleverman powers, the realisation that his heedless younger brother has been chosen threatens to destroy him.

In a world ruled by fear, hate and greed, can civilisation – and the power of the Cleverman – restore balance against known and unknown threats that stand to terrorise every species on Earth?

At the heart of the story are two estranged brothers, Koen and Waruu West, who are forced together to fight against terrifying enemies – both human and not of this world. But can Koen, a man bestowed with a powerful gift and destined to become the Cleverman, learn to harness his power before everything around him crumbles?



STORY DIRECTION

Beneath its high concept gloss, CLEVERMAN is a 6 x one-hour relationship drama about a group of people, many of whom have a supernatural gift or quality. The show's aim is to balance strong character stories with high-stakes action, political intrigue and social commentary.

Central to this series is the story of two estranged Indigenous brothers – Waruu and Koen West - who are forced together to fight for their own survival. The characters are at constant risk. They are fugitives and fighters, always on the run. While their world is heightened, the characters' emotional responses remain grounded in reality. These are characters that audiences can relate to, in a setting that becomes a character of its own. This is a dangerous world they live in.

THE CLEVERMAN WORLD

CLEVERMAN moves between two worlds – the City, and The Zone.

The City

The City is the regular world we familiarise with where people live, love, work, play, raise families and pay too much tax. The striking difference between a city of our time and the time of CLEVERMAN, is the high presence of uniformed, armed Containment Officers. They are everywhere, keeping the streets 'safe' from the 'threat' of what are termed by the government as "sub-humans" – the *Hairypeople*. Backing up the Containment Officers is a campaign of informing – billposters everywhere which exhort responsible City citizens to call the Containment Authority the moment they sight a Hairy in The City.

The Zone

The Zone is a haven for Hairies who no longer feel safe in the City. Although it was once a place inhabited largely by the disenfranchised and the poor, The Zone is now a place where Hairies can find comfort, support and community within its borders. Ironically, this has played right into the hands of authorities, who have decided that the Hairies had done most of the hard work of rounding themselves up. The government neatly finished the job by building an impenetrable wall around The Zone. Hairies living within The Zone are not permitted to leave, and any humans trapped there must move in and out through a heavily guarded checkpoint.



SPECIAL EFFECTS 'VFX' AND DESIGN

CLEVERMAN is set in the near future in an urban environment – but so far in the future that the producers could not make use of our current cityscapes. Derelict train stations, homes and offices all bear resemblance to current day technologies and practices. However, CLEVERMAN adopts several speculative concepts and notions that support the show's science fiction genre. In the series, these futuristic concepts are largely portrayed through the use of special effects.

Park Road Post in New Zealand created the special effects for CLEVERMAN, including the Dreaming creature the Namoroodor.

A major consideration for the creative producers of CLEVERMAN was the realisation of the Hairypeople. Production companies Australian Goalpost Pictures and New Zealand's Pukeko Pictures, engaged the renowned New Zealand Weta Workshop to create the supernatural elements and spiritual creatures depicted in CLEVERMAN.

The Hairypeople or 'Hairies' are designed by Jacob (Jake) Nash, production designer for Australia's leading Aboriginal Dance company Bangarra. Jake, alongside the acclaimed WETA workshop (whose previous work includes *The Lord of The Rings*, *Avatar*, *Godzilla*, *Elysium*, *District 9*) brought these creatures to life.

The Hairypeople speak an Indigenous language – Gumbaynggirr, from Australia's east coast. The producers worked with Indigenous Dialect Coach Mahjid Heath and Uncle Gary Williams from the Muurrbay Language Centre to teach the actors this ancient language.

Emotionally and physically, the feel and approach to the Hairies is raw, striking, strong, spiritual and indefinable. Rarriwuy Hick, who plays Latani, sums what it was like to act as a Hairie.

'Hair and makeup, so that was three hours in the chair. Day one I got up at 3am so that I could sit in the chair and get my hair and makeup done. It's so much fun. It's like you become like a different person or you're some sort of creature and it's amazing and they have these incredible blue eyes and they're just beautiful. Hairies are just so beautiful.'

Sir Richard Taylor, founder and Creative Director of Weta Workshop, explains about the creative process:

'The challenge to realise a piece of mythological story telling told verbally and to some degree illustrated, but in historical paintings on stone walls therefore at a very, very highly stylised manner, into a physical reality was decidedly tricky and not having a very intimate connection with it personally as a design team, it was very important that we stepped lightly and we stepped conscientiously through this complex early design phase.'

'We had to think about their fingernails through to their eye colour, about what direction their hair grew on their bodies, the hair direction on their face... because Hairies have never been seen before in this context, it's about discovery, and it's months and months of work, to try and find what's right for our show and to make them feel grounded and real and culturally authentic.'

CHARACTER STUDY

THE HAIRYPEOPLE

Over the last 60,000 years Aboriginal peoples have passed downs stories from one generation to the next. The creatures from these stories have inspired the concept of CLEVERMAN's Hairypeople.

In the world of CLEVERMAN, the Hairypeople are known to be the first inhabitants of the Australian continent. Known colloquially as Hairies, they are visually, physically and spiritually of this land. They live for more than 200 years with strength, health and metaphysical awareness. Honouring old age and wisdom, Hairies perceive their journey toward death as spiritually awakening.

Hairypeople do not share the same DNA as humans, making them a different species. Yet they do share a deep knowledge and understanding of land, culture and Dreaming with the Indigenous community thereby nurturing mutual affinity and respect.

The Hairy community has as much diversity as any other community with differences in attitudes, opinions and personal style. For example, there are 'shavers' who learn English and choose to remove their hair in order to blend in with society, and there are 'non-shavers' who defiantly live their lives as they always have covered in a thick coat of hair from head to toe and often speaking traditional language.

KOEN WEST

Protagonist Koen West doesn't walk, he struts. He is impulsive, physical and has all the confidence of a king. The classic bad boy women think they can change. But his 'badness' comes from a deeper place, a darker one: the product of an affair between an Aboriginal father and white mother and orphaned in a car accident, Koen was born alone. He's an outsider; caught between two worlds, two cultures. Blamed and bullied by his half-brother Waruu (Rob Collins) for the death of their father, Koen turned his back on his community, and chose to live a totally separate life.

As a result, he's learned to look out for Number One – if there's nothing in a situation that's going to benefit him personally, Koen's not interested. He's an irresponsible hedonist who doesn't trust anyone except his best mate, Blair (Ryan Corr).

Though he is aware of his Aboriginality, Koen is not connected to his culture, in fact he actively denies it. He has no language and only a limited understanding of his Dreaming.

His disregard in scamming Hairypeople demonstrates that he is morally flexible. He can shift perspectives on things, depending on which version suits him best at the time. He will apply the same flexibility when something very strange starts to happen to him...

Like most of us, he is contradictory; cocky in his professional life, and yet generous to the few people close to him. He'll do anything for his best mate, Blair. And – as misguided as the situation is – he cares for Ash (Blair's girlfriend and

Koen's occasional lover), and is gentle with her. Deep down, Koen doesn't believe he is worthy of love. Though he craves it. Badly.

That – and a place to belong.

WARUU WEST

Waruu is a self-appointed leader, an inspirational force; an altruistic figure who protects the vulnerable in an intolerant, volatile world. He is charismatic and intimidating. Status is important to him – it's something he felt a lack of, growing up without a father. As much as he is driven to help his people, his 'family', Waruu is also driven by ego. He truly believes that he can lead 'his' people out of the darkness. And sometimes this focus on the greater good means that his own family gets left behind. He's not quite as absent as his own father, but his eye is always on the bigger picture.

After his father died, Uncle Jimmy (Jack Charles) became Waruu's father figure, and as Waruu learned the traditional ways and stories from Jimmy, he came to believe that the role of Cleverman was his rightful destiny. He would keep his people, his 'family' safe, something his father was unable to do. To have that legacy taken from him by his brother, the man he hates most in the world, is gutting for Waruu. And it is this hatred for Koen, and his fury at not inheriting the role of Cleverman, that will push Waruu to an unthinkable act of betrayal...

JARROD SLADE

As founder and CEO of Slade Industries, Slade's reach extends to TV networks, manufacturing, and more, all built upon a formidable intelligence and magnetic charisma. This drawing power makes Slade accessible. Someone you could share a beer and a laugh with. A cultural scholar, he's a citizen of the world who is as much at ease kicking a football with a bunch of kids as he is addressing a global summit.

Slade is married to Charlotte, an educated and highly intelligent doctor, who does pro-bono medical work in The Zone and is proud of her husband's self-made empire and strong moral 'principles'. And yet, bubbling underneath Slade's noble intentions is a much deeper purpose.

For all the value he places on social equality and ethnic parity, Slade is a man who believes in the power of science. A man who uses his incredible fortune to help mankind, but a man whose particular passion lies in seeking a cure for the incurable: death. And for an intellectual – whose historical, anthropological and scientific thirst for knowledge is boundless – the emergence of the Hairies presents an incredible opportunity...

The pragmatism of a mogul is being able to turn a blind eye to the morally reprehensible in favour of what one sees as a greater good. This pragmatism is hard-wired into Slade's DNA. Charlotte fell in love with him because he is so relatable, intelligent and worldly, but at his core, Slade is a man who will do whatever it takes...

CHARLOTTE CLEARY

Charlotte Cleary is a woman unto herself. Her husband might be Jarrod Slade – media mogul – but Charlotte steadfastly refuses to allow her marriage to define her. She is a bright, educated woman – a doctor whose intelligence is outweighed only by an unwavering morality.

She married Slade for his quick laugh, his brilliance and his vast worldly knowledge. She is very much in love with her husband, though as the series progresses, there's something that's increasingly disconcerting about him.

The one thing missing in Charlotte's life is a child. She knows it is a cliché for a woman of a certain age to be driven by the biological imperative to reproduce, but nevertheless she cannot deny that that drive is within her. Having endured a number of IVF procedures, Charlotte decides that the physical and emotional toll – with no success in sight – is too great. It's time to draw a line in the sand.

UNCLE JIMMY

Uncle Jimmy is Waruu and Koen's uncle – the brother of their deceased father. And he came to be a real father figure for them, teaching them everything about culture that he could.

But he is a man in conflict. Beleaguered by the voices in his head, as much as the voices around him demanding his help, Jimmy has not held firm. He's drifted from the community and into the pathway of the charismatic Jarrod Slade. As opposed to many of the younger generations in his community, Slade is someone actually interested in Jimmy and the stories he has to tell. Slade wants to know *everything*. Flattered by his interest, though perhaps misguided, and enticed by money too, Jimmy shares many secrets with Slade, many more than he is entitled to. And he starts to lose control of the situation, giving things to Slade he never thought he would.

Now it is time for Jimmy to make amends for what he's done. Time to reassert the power of the Cleverman, although, not in the form that anyone would have predicted.

BOONDEE

Boondee is a Hairy. A devoted husband to Araluen and loving father to Latani, Djukara and Jirra, he is a resilient spiritual man who sees his own strong pragmatism as the glue holding his family together.

Boondee believes that his family will be unharmed if they shave down and assimilate within the greater community in the City. This is difficult for a man so profoundly connected to his culture – after all, hiding your true self does take its emotional toll – but it's a price he is willing to pay if it will keep his family safe.

Boondee is old enough to understand what happens to those who try to mess with the humans. Born soon after colonisation, he saw first hand the devastating effects of whitefella settlement on the Indigenous peoples and, under the instruction of Hairy elders, stepped back to allow the blackfellas to fight the fight.

Now, with the Hairies finally exposed as what they truly are, he remembers only the advice of his forebears "we will outlive

this", "survive, not struggle". Knowing that his people live for 200 years, Boondee is happy to bide his time because things will get better with time... this too shall pass.

ARALUEN

Araluen is a proud Hairy woman with a strong survival instinct who is beautiful, fierce and earthly. As a mother, she is prepared to do whatever it takes to find and care for her children. Araluen is warm-hearted and protective of her own, so protective, in fact, that she and her husband Boondee shave down, and insist that their children Djukara, Latani and Jirra follow suit. In this way they can appear human, blend in, become anonymous. Because with anonymity, comes safety. And with safety, comes peace. Boondee and Araluen believe that if they manage to lie low they will outlast the crisis facing their people.

Their children – especially Djukara – don't quite feel the same way. It's this undeterred faith in an eventual end to the madness, the disappearances – the idea of outliving her enemies – that give Araluen hope. But it's a hope that'll be dragged through the worst kind of hell before it sees any kind of fulfilment. She is isolated from her family and must fight to be reunited with them, and for her own survival. And it is during this struggle that she will learn that even she is capable of murder.

DJUKARA

Son of Boondee and Araluen, Djukara is a hardheaded teenager with a chip on his shoulder. An anti-authoritarian youth rendered voiceless by the skin (or, rather, Hair) he was born into, he has a reckless self-belief that is only enflamed by the subjugation of his people.

Djukara is a blank canvas whose body becomes a site upon which all of his anger, fear, frustration and fire find visual expression. His hair – once a reminder of the wreckage of his family – becomes a powerful symbol of strength, force and defiance. Djukara uses his pelt to define him. It is at once his armor and his weapon. It empowers him to empower his compatriots.

Underneath the tough bravado, however, Djukara is just an innocent kid with a good heart. He holds onto things emotionally – a fact that may well be his downfall as the world around him changes. Already enraged by his people's inability to live freely and proudly, and pushed to fury by the destruction of his family, Djukara is at breaking point.

LATANI

Latani is just like her father, Boondee. She's prepared to be patient, to wait out the troubles, and then return to a peaceful life. The only problem is that this world won't let her live the way she and her father would like to. Stranded on her own in the city, Latani discovers within herself a ferocious will to survive, and the brains, and determination to make it possible. And she's a young woman discovering that possessing strength far greater than any human, can have its advantages.

Through her friendship with Alinta, Latani realizes that it is perfectly possible for humans and Hairies to happily co-exist, a belief that outs her into direct conflict with her increasingly radicalized brother.

COMMENTS FROM THE CAST

Hunter Page-Lochard (Koen West)

'Koen is a lost boy to begin with. He's hurt. He lost his parents at a very young age and his older brother always treated him as though it was his fault. He's kind of had to learn a sense of maturity and responsibility on his own, to the point where he's a little too cocky. At the beginning of the series Koen is someone who feels that he's learnt it all, because he's had to. This makes him a proud and strong person, but also a reckless person. When he gets the Cleverman powers, it's more of a shock to him than it is to anyone else.'

Rob Collins (Waruu West)

"Waruu is the self-appointed leader of The Zone. He's a protector, he's an advocate for these people and he sees himself as the chief architect of changing or bettering their lifestyles. He's an ambitious character. He's fierce, he's determined, he's respected by his people, he's a family man, he's a father but ultimately his drive and his ambition become directed towards himself and less for his people and he gets clouded by his own ambition."

Iain Glen (Jarrod Slade)

"The series delves into the idea of how to live together in harmony in a way that's interesting and different. It doesn't bang the issue on the head, it's very subtly evolved I think."

Frances O'Connor (Charlotte Cleary)

"What this series is saying culturally and what it's saying politically are really timely and interesting and I just really wanted to be a part of it I think."

"I think the increasing distance between rich and poor it's happening in a lot of different cultures, as is the segregation between the people who don't have a voice politically, and the people that do. So CLEVERMAN is touching on a universal theme that is also very particular to Australia at this current time."

Ryan Corr (Blair Finch)

"It's shows like this that are sort of forefront in the movement to colour blind casting... it's not a show that's about Aboriginal or non-Aboriginal or... or white or pink or blue people. It's about people. It's a world that exists unto its own. It's a world that doesn't have any rules, and it's a really good drama."

Rarriwuy Hick (Latani)

'The character I play is a 15-year-old girl and just like any teenager she's trying to work out what she wants to do in life but then she has an even bigger obstacle than most teenagers because she's a Hairy and it's quite dangerous for her to live amongst human beings. Quite early in the story she loses her family and she has to fight for herself and survive.'

Stef Dawson (Ash Kerry)

"I also think this is a special story because it deals with the concept of otherness. The Hairies embody all kinds of others - anyone who doesn't fit into society's norms anyone treated with disrespect, or kept at arm's length. And it's society's reaction to them, whether they're treated as creatures or animals. The way people see Hairies in this show is going to be very interesting, and very poignant."

Deborah Mailman (Aunty Linda)

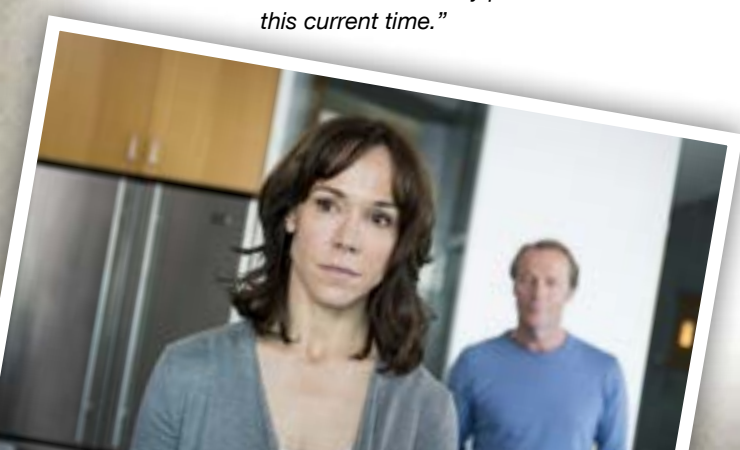
"Aunty Linda has a tough, resilient, no-nonsense quality of character. She's been diagnosed with an aggressive form of cancer. Like Waruu and Koen and Uncle Jimmy she's a very spiritual woman. She has a really strong connection and understanding to the spirit world and towards the end of the series she plays quite a significant role in helping Koen and Waruu through their journeys."

Tony Briggs (Boondee)

'I'm a father of three so it was easy for me to relate to Boondee's actions... imagining myself in an apocalyptic type of scenario with my children asking myself, "what would I do?" - and the number one priority is to keep your family safe. That's Boondee's focus. His love for his family is first and foremost and his determination to keep them alive. He's a character with incredible integrity.'

Tasma Walton (Araluen)

'Our Hairy people family sat down and had an in depth conversations about the backstory, and talked about how the concept of the hairy person can differ between various Indigenous clans.'





STORYLINE

EPISODE 1: In the near future a series of unexplained violent attacks in the city are blamed on the newly discovered 'Hairypeople', who have been living and passing amongst us.

EPISODE 2: Koen is mystified by his strange new powers. Looking for answers, he heads into The Zone. Aunty Linda realises there is a new Cleverman.

EPISODE 3: A murder and a breakout at the Containment Centre creates further panic. Both Waruu and Koen reject Slade's overtures to help in a mysterious laboratory.

EPISODE 4: The Hairies are blamed for the continuing deaths. As tensions mount, Waruu demands Koen use his Cleverman powers to halt the murders.

EPISODE 5: Charlotte agrees to one last attempt at IVF at a clinic offering new technology. Slade offers Waruu a deal he struggles to refuse.

EPISODE 6: As the Containment Authority prepares to clear the city of Hairypeople, Koen must finally face his destiny as a Cleverman.

KEY CURRICULUM RELATED THEMES

Power

Power relations are explored throughout CLEVERMAN explicitly, visually, and through language. The storyline is driven by characters in power such as politicians, corporations and state officials such as the army and police in juxtaposition to those socially marginalised without power: the poor, the homeless and cultural minorities. This binary is portrayed visually as scenes move between the lives of humans and those of 'Othered' species. Students also witness the power of language in demeaning whole groups of people. Yet, the lead protagonist, Koen, illustrates that power can be inherent and have the most influence through the positive actions of individuals.

Identity

With his newly appointed responsibilities, Koen is caught between two cultures. His new title forces him to read-dress not only his identity as a man, but also his identity as an Indigenous leader. Yet Koen isn't the only one battling with his identity throughout the CLEVERMAN series. What it means to be cast as an outsider from society forms the underlying plot throughout the series, as Hairies fight for their right to be recognised as citizens, just as other marginalised groups have fought for equality preceding them. CLEVERMAN interrogates what it is to have an Australian identity and whether it is a given right available to all.

Media Influence

CLEVERMAN reveals the favourable relationship that can exist between politics, powerful corporations and the media. The influence that the media has in shaping public perception can have serious repercussions that affect the everyday lives of marginalised peoples. CLEVERMAN illustrates this in the selective reporting of the News as well as depicting how politicians and stakeholders alike can manipulate the stories that are reported. Only by questioning the integrity of all sources, can individuals make decisions about who and what influences them. CLEVERMAN encourages students to be critical analysers of the world around them.





EPISODE 1 SYNOPSIS

FIRST CONTACT

The world is more or less as we know it, except that it has been discovered that a species called 'Hairypeople' have been living and passing amongst us, without our knowledge. They look human, except that they are covered in hair, possess exceptional strength, and can live to two hundred years or more. They have 'passed' as human by shaving their hair off.

Most Hairypeople live in The Zone, a ghetto where the disenfranchised and the poor live. Along with Hairypeople, The Zone community includes Indigenous people and various other ethnic groups. The government has walled off this area to keep the Hairypeople in. Humans may come and go as they please, as long as they show their IDs. Hairies are not issued with IDs.

Koen and his friend Blair smuggle a Hairy family out of The Zone, and into an apartment in the city. It's obviously something they've done before. Despite being unhappy with the standard of the place, Boondee, the father, pays Koen in cash. But once Koen's back in his cool inner city bar that he runs with his friends Blair and Ash, he rings the Containment Authority, reports the family and their whereabouts and claims the reward. A retrieval team is sent to capture them, and in the process Jirra, the family's young daughter is shot and killed.

Footage of the Hairy girl's shooting is played on TVs across the city and in The Zone. Jarrod Slade, a wealthy businessman, owns the TV network that has exclusive rights to the

footage. He even sent a crew there to cover the raid before it happened. Clearly he has connections. But Matthews, the Minister for Immigration and Border Protection, is angry that the footage is played and threatens to shut down Slade's network. Slade seems unperturbed.

Waruu, the self-appointed spokesman for the various peoples of The Zone, watches the footage with his family. He is horrified at the shooting and is determined to wipe out this heinous people smuggling. Waruu is under pressure from both the humans and the Hairies in The Zone, as each are vying to have their grievances seen to.

Waruu believes in unity. He is sure that when his Uncle Jimmy, the Cleverman, passes on, the Cleverman powers will come to him, giving him more status within the community. He's been preparing to take on the Cleverman mantle since he was a child.

But, the Cleverman powers do not go to Waruu but to Koen – who, we discover, is Waruu's estranged half-brother. After visiting Koen in his bar and giving him a special club called a nulla nulla, Uncle Jimmy sacrifices himself on a beach to some unseen beast. On seeing Jimmy's body, Waruu knows immediately what ripped out Uncle Jimmy's heart out – a beast called a Namorrodor.

Koen turns up at Uncle Jimmy's funeral to triumphantly show Waruu his new blue eye, and his minty new/old finger when he's called by an insistent voice – the voice of the Cleverman.

EPISODE 1 LEARNING

» POWER

Clear depictions of power, or lack thereof, form the backdrop of each scene in *CLEVERMAN*. Government buildings, offices and luxurious mansions form the scenery of white power, while that of The Zone are harsh and derelict third world conditions. Language is also an incredibly powerful tool, simply by assigning a group of people a label hinders their ability to challenge preconceived ideas about them. Similarly, by denying a group of people the right to speak their own language denies their agency and ability to practice their own culture. *CLEVERMAN* highlights the power of the police, government and wealthy.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Human rights must be violated in certain instances to protect the safety of society.
2. The poor, the unemployed and the homeless have nothing standing in their way to achieve the same quality of life as the rest of Australia.



Short answer questions

1. List the different imagery depicting a power imbalance throughout the episode.
2. How was language used to keep down the minority groups and by whom?
3. Why would the government “love it” when the group in The Zone is divided?
4. Who was terrorised and subjected to police brutality throughout this episode? Do you think that the white citizens would be subject to the same abuse? Why/why not?
5. Explain how denying someone to speak their own language could be incredibly damaging.

Essay topic

Those in positions of power in society such as the police, the government and other institutions have a responsibility. Explain.

Classroom activity

Split the class into three groups and assign each group one of the following to research:

- i) The Universal Declaration of Human Rights
- ii) The United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples
- iii) The United Nations Convention on the Rights of a Child

Each group must find the following from their assigned declaration:

- a) The rights that have been abused in the film. List examples.
- b) Which of the listed rights the group considers the most important.
- c) List the rights that the group believes have been, or continues to be, abused in Australia. List examples.

Each group assign a spokesperson to share the group’s findings with the rest of the class.



» IDENTITY

Koen is clearly battling, or resisting, his own identity both as a man and as an Indigenous man. *CLEVERMAN* explores how people are made up of multiple identities that can interlink but also contradict each other. Simply by having 80% of its cast made up of Indigenous people, *CLEVERMAN* finally provides Indigenous Australians with an Indigenous superhero and role model on mainstream television.

Discussion and/or debate topics

1. Language is the most important pillar of one's identity, hence if a language dies – the survival of one's identity is jeopardised.
2. You are either Indigenous, or not Indigenous. You cannot identify as both.

Short answer questions

1. What are the repercussions of the government's decision not to issue Hairies with IDs.
2. Why do you think Koen has seemingly abandoned his culture?
3. 80% of the cast of *Cleverman* identify as Indigenous. Can you think of any other films or television series that have had a similar representation? Explain your answer.
4. Community is vital in times of crisis. List five reasons why.

5. How does language play a role in one's identity?

Essay topic

Increased Indigenous perspectives in the media are crucial to reconciliation. Discuss.

Classroom activity

As a class, brainstorm the different factors that make up one's identity. For instance, culture, gender, etc. Lead a discussion with the following prompts:

- Are these multiple identities are fixed or can they change?
- Does an individual define their identity or do others assign it?
- Which of these identities are the most important?
- Can they be ordered in a hierarchy from most important to least important? Why/why not?
- Offer the opportunity for students to share what they believe make up their own identity if they feel comfortable to.





» MEDIA INFLUENCE

The opening scenes of *CLEVERMAN* depict the choices that media corporations make in regards to reporting. The media holds a lot of power to influence public opinion by the stories it chooses to cover and the ways they report. The death of a small girl was flashed across the television for all to see, when this probably would never occur if she was not a Hairy.

Discussion/debate topics

1. News programs tell the truth and hold ultimate credibility.
2. All groups within Australian society are represented adequately in the media.

Short answer questions

1. Describe what sort of stories you believe should be reported on in the news.
2. List all of the different news programs you know and what channel they are on.
3. For each listing, describe who you think the desired audience is for the program.
4. Explain how you think different audiences may or may not affect the reporting and stories covered in these programs.
5. What groups are always included in what is portrayed in the media? Who are excluded?

Essay topic

Reporting of the news can never be independent and unbiased. Explain.

Classroom activity

In small groups, devise an interview to conduct on a student or group of students during lunchtime. Assign roles within the group so that the interview is adequately recorded in order to share next class. In your planning, outline the following:

- Who you intend to interview
- Why you intend to interview them
- What story you hope to report
- Factors that you believe might influence your interview

After your interview has taken place, report to your peers during your next class. Ensure that you reflect on the story that you have reported and how it came about.





EPISODE 2 SYNOPSIS

CONTAINMENT

A young boy playing soccer has his heart ripped out of his chest by something other worldly. This plays perfectly into Minister Matthews' hands, who uses this as the basis for a story about how volatile and violent Hairymen can be.

Koen, looking for answers, heads into The Zone to find Auntie Linda, the woman who raised him after his parents were both killed in a hit and run accident. As he hugs her in greeting, he gets a vision of her undergoing medical treatment for breast cancer. She, in turn, sees his one blue eye and realises he has been given the Cleverman powers – she knows how distressed this will make her son, Waruu.

Waruu, meanwhile, is in consultation with Harry, his unofficial second. Harry has surveillance photos of suspicious, unmarked semi-trailers heading into an old abandoned prison. Harry wants to raid the complex, but Waruu urges caution. And a political solution. He's going on TV – on a station owned by Jarrod Slade, no less - to debate with Minister Matthews.

Waruu starts strongly in the debate, skewering Matthews about the fact many Hairymen are disappearing without a trace, distressing families. But the interview is interrupted with a highly inflammatory report on the brutal death of

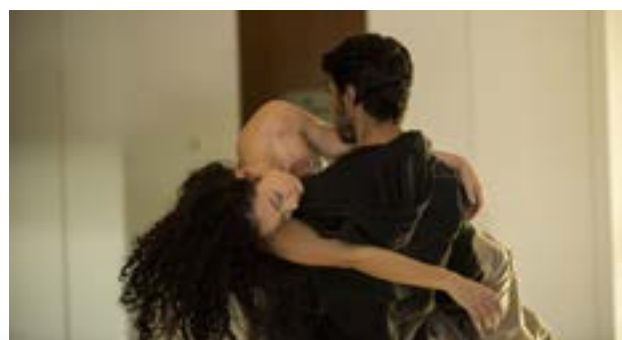
Cameron Wells, laying the blame squarely at the feet of Hairymen. Waruu has been outplayed, and is furious. Matthews, on the other hand, is delighted.

Djukara, the son of the Hairy family captured by the Containment Authority, is refusing to bow to the authority of the guards. His relief in discovering his father is captive in the same place is short-lived, when his father refuses to countenance any form of fighting back. Boondie's approach is to submit, knowing the Hairies will outlive their captors. But Djukara refuses to co-operate, leading to the guards torturing Boondie in front of him, and then shaving all of Djukara's hair off, as a warning to others about insubordination.

Latani, Djukara's sister, who hid from the guards during the raid, is befriended by an old woman called Virgil, who is not phased by the fact she's a Hairy. Virgil provides Latani with ID, and Latani flees into the streets.

Araluen, Latani's mother, is taken to a medical bay in the Containment Authority, along with two other female Hairies. Frankie, who's looking for a volunteer, inspects them like livestock. Araluen volunteers, even though she doesn't know what for, and the other two are promptly shot dead in front of her. The job Araluen has 'volunteered' for is in a brothel, as a sex worker. She is imprisoned as a sex slave.

At first the Cleverman powers are a bit of a joke between Koen and his friends – if he cuts himself the wound heals in front of their eyes. But things turn serious when he is plagued by a voice in his head, calling him. The voice leads him and Blair to a mysterious laboratory, where they find a woman strapped to a table, full of tubes. They rescue her – and flee the lab – only for Koen to discover that this strange woman is something magical.





EPISODE 2 LEARNING

» POWER

This episode explores the notion of power exerted by the State as Hairies are contained within the wall of The Zone. The government holds the power to define who is a citizen and who is not a citizen with the enforcement of heavily armed ID checkpoints. Koen is becoming more aware of his responsibilities and powers as a Cleverman, while his half-brother Waruu resents his brother for being handed the title. Meanwhile, Hairies endure brutal torture in jail as the prison wardens exert their power through violence against both men and women.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. It is okay for me to not participate in fighting for equal rights if it doesn't affect me.
2. Having the different groups within society separate is a good thing.

Short answer questions

1. What is racial profiling? When do you believe it occurs?
2. When inspecting the female prisoners like livestock, Frankie, refers to the women as dogs. Similarly, humans frequently refer to the Hairies as monkeys. Explain why you think these people choose to use language that dehumanises the Hairies.
3. What is the desired effect of building a wall between communities? What are the short and long-term problems?
4. In the jail, the prison wardens use torture methods used historically back in England on their prisoners. Why do you think torture was used in the past? Who do you think torture is continuing to be inflicted upon in the present day and by whom?
5. It is clear that Hairy prisoner, Djukara, is resilient and refuses to bow down to the authority of the guards. Meanwhile his father Boondee submits and complies with their orders. Explain which method you believe you would take if you were in this situation and why.

Essay topic

The violence inflicted upon the Hairies is condoned and legislated by white authority. This would unlikely occur if the circumstances were reversed. Why/why not?

Classroom activity

- Follow this link to an article from The Guardian: <http://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/video/2016/jan/13/marlon-james-are-you-racist-video>
- Watch the video and lead a class discussion about being a non-racist or an anti-racist.
- Conclude by brainstorming ways to stop racism as a class.

» IDENTITY

Koen struggles with his identity not only as an Indigenous man with newly appointed responsibilities, but also from issues embedded in his family history. He questions why Uncle Jimmy chose him to be his predecessor as Cleverman instead of his half-brother. He seems to have abandoned his upbringing in The Zone, wanting to make a life for himself running a bar. Issues of identity being associated with the colour of one's skin and bloodline are explored as his half-brother Waruu accuses Koen of being a "coconut" and the son of a "white whore". Meanwhile, Latani begins to discover her own identity as a Hairy in a non-Hairy world without the support of her family.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Your family is first and foremost whom you are related to by blood.
2. Waruu states, "Don't tell me I don't get it. I'm a black fella. You heard what Matthews said to me in there... I'm a pariah in my own country". Who are considered outsiders in Australia and why?

Short answer questions

1. Why do you think Koen is struggling so much with owning his new title as a Cleverman?
2. Explain what you think is meant by Frankie asking, "Are you a natural?" When is it appropriate to ever use language like this?
3. Some Hairies choose to "shave down" so that they can be free of ridicule and persecution in their community. List other minority groups that may compromise the way they look or act in order to avoid everyday harassment or discrimination in your community. Explain why you think that this is acceptable or not acceptable.
4. Brainstorm what you think the qualities of a good person are and write them down.
5. Despite growing up in The Zone, why was Koen picked on when he returned?

Essay topic

A "natural" person does not exist. Do you agree? Discuss this in relation to feeling a sense of belonging to a group and/or place.

Classroom activity

- As a class, brainstorm the different times throughout history when peoples have been discriminated against due to the colour of their skin.
- Research or watch a short film on Apartheid, the Civil Rights Movement, the Stolen Generations or World War II.
- How was each of these movements similar? How were they each unique?
- List the characteristics that were considered favourable and unfavourable during these movements. Discuss



why the class thinks this was.

- What happens to those people who were caught in-between? For instance, Indian people living in South Africa during Apartheid and people such as Koen living in Australia?

» MEDIA INFLUENCE

There are grave differences in the ways stories are reported on in the media between humans and Hairies. In relation to the death of a schoolboy, Waruu states in his television interview "we must let the judicial system handle this and not the media", highlighting that there are great dangers in the media jumping to conclusions. News reporter, Belinda, shares confidential information regarding the death of Uncle Jimmy, while journalist Jane O'Grady incriminates Hairies by suggesting that "subhumans" were responsible for the crime due to their "incredibly strong fingernails". The episode illustrated how reporting can manipulate public perception and drive political agenda in certain ways.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Series concept creator and producer, Ryan Griffen, developed this series so that his son had an Indigenous superhero to look up to as a role model. Why is there a severe lack of Indigenous presence portrayed in the media?
2. Language used in the media is one of the most powerful tools. Discuss.

Short answer questions

1. Waruu wants to show the public what the Minister for



Essay topic

Producer Rosemary Blight discussed the importance of stories and the importance of listening:

"There are no books which say these are the following 300 Aboriginal stories, there's no text, there's no Aboriginal Shakespeare. So you have to listen. You've got to sit in rooms with people who have been handed the stories down from generation to generation to generation. So we spent a lot of time talking and listening and talking and listening so that the stories could bubble up."

Western knowledge has a history of being written down and a reliance of books, textbooks, essays, newspapers and the like. However how did we learn prior to this? If knowledge doesn't exist in print does it exist at all? Is western knowledge taken more seriously than Indigenous knowledge? Why/why not? Explore these ideas in an essay.

Classroom activity

As a class, watch any episode of a current affairs program on a commercial channel such as *Today Tonight* or *A Current Affair* (preferably one with the greatest reach nationally in terms of viewers). Throughout their viewing, ask each student to make note of the following in order to discuss as a class afterwards:

- What stories are covered?
- What nationalities are depicted and in what way?
- Is the reporting favourable to a certain party? How?
- What methods are used to convey the 'bad' against the 'good'?
- Consider the how certain reporting can effect the portrayal of certain people.
- What are the settings certain people are interviewed in front of?
- What background music is used?
- What camera angles and effects are utilised?
- Does the reporter seem to be favourable towards one person/group or side of the story?
- Are all sides of the story given the same amount of coverage?

Immigration and Border Protection, Matthews, "is so desperate for them not to see". Yet, his right-hand man Harry replies that "we're not like them, so they don't care". What does he mean by this? Is this relevant in any way in your community?

2. Waruu believes that the government through the media is manipulating public perception. How do you think this can occur?
3. News journalist, Belinda, describes the death of the schoolboy causing "a terrible sense of despair and growing fear at tonight's events... And not just because of Cameron's tender age, but the particularly brutal way in which he was killed in front of his club mates". However, in the first episode the brutal murder of the Hairy girl of a younger age at the hand of the State was televised across the screens. Explain why the death of the Hairy was not given the same respect.
4. How can reporting in the media effect the story it is reporting?
5. What differences in language, camera angles and content can you identify in the different media reports in the series so far?





EPISODE 3 SYNOPSIS

A FREE RANGER

Waruu and Harry break in to the Containment Centre on their reconnaissance mission, filming the deplorable conditions the inmates are kept in.

But when Djukara appeals to Harry, as a fellow Hairy, to let them out, Harry can't refuse. Three prisoners pile out, a guard appears, and Djukara is shot. Waruu, rushes to Djukara's aid, and pulls the guard off him, trapping him in a headlock.

Waruu, Harry, and the prisoners escape to The Zone, and take Djukara to the medical clinic for assistance. He's tended by Slade's wife Charlotte, a doctor. She's thrown when she realises Djukara is an escapee – even more so when the new reports state that a guard was killed in the breakout. And that his heart was ripped out. Waruu is furious, and assures everyone that the boys did not kill the guard, let alone rip his heart out.

What Waruu does not know is that McIntyre, the head of the Containment Authority, has used his own knife to remove the guard's heart, to frame the Hairy escapees. Matthews, unaware of this, demands the Hairy story be broadcast for the world to see that the vicious Hairies have struck again.

Koen and Blair, along with Blair's girlfriend Ash, have dubbed the mystery woman from the lab 'Kora', and are trying to work out who and what she is. But she won't, or

can't, talk, and behaves as if she from another world and time, intrigued by all she comes across. When Koen grabs Kora's arm in frustration at her silence, he is knocked clear across the room by a jolt of extraordinary power.

Latani is on the streets, trying to find her way back to The Zone and safety. When chased by a couple of Containment Officers, she seeks shelter in a hairdressing salon, only to be captured by the workers there, who want to make a profit out of selling her pelt. As the bids mount for her hair, Latani uses her razor sharp nails to make her escape.

It turns out that Slade is the owner of the lab in which Kora was found. He's a man with an established interest in Indigenous culture; a man who was a friend and business associate of Uncle Jimmy's. He wants to know who the new Cleverman is – so that he can continue the work he started with Jimmy. Slade enters The Zone to find Waruu, who he assumes is now Cleverman. But Waruu isn't interested in Slade's overtures, and Slade discovers Waruu is not the one. Koen is, but he rejects Slade and his offers of wealth and power, too.

Araluen is given a glamorous makeover at the brothel, and we discover the person most interested in her is Matthews himself – the politician hell bent on demonizing Hairies.

Nerida, Waruu's wife, has heard the reports of the breakout, and is beside herself with worry. But Waruu locks himself away from her, and obsessively watches the footage – which reveals he is the man who killed the guard. Not in self-defence, but by choice.



EPISODE 3 LEARNING

» POWER

Both humans and Hairies live in a world where drones, CCTV and police checkpoints monitor their everyday lives. Politics and corporations continue to curate the stories they wish to be reported in the media, as citizens confuse who “the authorities” really are. Founder and CEO of his own corporation that’s reach covers television networks and manufacturing, Slade begins his attempts to attain ancient Indigenous cultural knowledge. Meanwhile in a sick twist, Minister for Immigration and Border Control, Matthews, exerts his power over his sex slave Araluen who is a Hairy woman, despite being the very species his government is attempting to eradicate.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Surveillance of society is necessary for the protection of its citizens.
2. Money is power.

Short answer questions

1. What effect do you think drones have on society?
2. Define what you think a “Police State” is and why it is deemed necessary in some countries.
3. Why is sexual slavery one of the most powerful forms of torture and control?
4. What would such a powerful businessman as Slade want to do with “lucrative” Indigenous cultural knowledge?
5. What are the different structures of power in society? Are they necessary?

Essay topic

“You always want what you can’t have” is a well-known quote. Explore how the unattainable and the forbidden are desired in CLEVERMAN.

Classroom activity

Watch a short video on Edward Said’s theory ‘Orientalism’. Discuss as a class how these ideas can be applied to the treatment of Hairies in CLEVERMAN.

For instance, despite being feared and hated by many humans, trading the hair of Hairies attracts large sums of money. Similarly, members of parliament sexually exploit Hairies, despite their policies directly disenfranchising them as a group.



» IDENTITY

Solidarity between Indigenous and Hairy peoples are explored in Episode 3. During Waruu and Harry's break-in of the Containment Centre, prisoner Djukara appeals to Harry, as a fellow Hairy, to set them free. Meanwhile, Koen, Blair and Ash give the mystery woman from the lab 'Kora' as her identity remains unknown apart from the understanding that she is from another time and place. Meanwhile, the Hairy women, Araluen and Latani are individually given different makeovers questioning how much of one's identity is in their looks.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Recognition by the government is crucial to one's identity.
2. Justice should always prevail, regardless of whether you believe in the cause.

Short answer questions

1. The government considers Hairies as a problem people. What effect would this have on Hairies as a group and as individuals?
2. Throughout this episode Hairies are continuously referred to as "animals" and "subhumans" or "sub-bies". Describe the process and implications of giving a group of people a discriminatory and denigrating label.
3. Does your loyalty to your friendship group or family



conquer all? Why/why not? Refer to specific examples.

4. What defines your identity? Can you ever fully belong to a place if you are from another?
5. How do you think the recognition of Indigenous peoples and their cultures is crucial to their identity?

Essay topic

Being an active and informed citizen is the pillar of a functioning society. With reference to three examples, why is this so?

Classroom activity

Investigate the current experience of refugees hoping for asylum in Australia. Take the time to discuss the following prompts:

- What are the reasons refugees are attempting to seek asylum?
- How many refugees are currently seeking asylum? Liken this amount to five separate unrelated populations for comparison (for instance, the same number of people as those who do not like chocolate in Australia).
- What countries are refugees coming from?
- What are the current political situations in these countries?
- What are the current living conditions and impacts of war in these countries?
- Who of the refugees are seeking asylum alone or with their families?
- Who has been left behind?
- What do you think the realistic impact of these refugees on Australian society is?
- What are the hopes of these refugees?
- How does Australia's willingness to help the refugee crisis make the country stronger?





» MEDIA INFLUENCE

Waruu and Harry break in to the Containment Centre so that they can film the deplorable conditions the inmates are kept in, since the media do not do this themselves. News reporting throws petrol on the flames of social panic as the Minister of Immigration and Border Control demands to “get the media in” so that the image of bloodshed “is beamed across every screen in the country”.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. The media should have the authority to decide what they want to report on and what to leave out.

Short answer questions

1. Why do you think it is not in the media's interest to report on the conditions within the Containment Centre?
2. Describe the ways in which Hairies are depicted as vicious murders in the media thus far.
3. It doesn't always take the media to explicitly report that something is 'bad' to influence public opinion. Comment on the effect of simply leaving certain things out of a report, or not reporting on an event at all.
4. Why is Waruu furious about the ways the media reports on issues regarding Hairy peoples?
5. The actions of the hairdressers were discovered due to their use of technology. List the different technologies that you use that could be linked to the authorities.

Essay topic

Explain the benefits better coverage of Indigenous issues in various media have to reconciliation efforts. Refer to television, film, newspapers and another source you can identify.

Classroom activity

Privacy is a thing of the past. Lead a class discussion about the ways the students' lives lack a sense of privacy.

- What effect does the media have over privacy?
- How does social media allow for a lack of privacy?
- Who deserves privacy?
- What issues and aspects of one's life should always be allowed privacy?
- How can we strengthen the control of privacy in our lives?





EPISODE 4 SYNOPSIS

SUN AND MOON

Eight people are killed in an aged care facility - all of them have their hearts ripped out. Again the government blames the Hairies. The media are calling it a massacre. Crowds of protestors gather at the checkpoint into The Zone, all too ready to condemn the 'subhumans'.

Tension is mounting between Waruu and the militant Hairyman Maliyan. Waruu believes strength lies in unity, but Maliyan wants the Hairies to stand for themselves. Always looking for a peaceful solution, Waruu asks Slade to send a film crew into The Zone, to show the 'other' side of the story. Slade agrees, and sends in Belinda - the reporter who has led the stories on the attacks blamed on the Hairies. And Waruu's erstwhile lover. His daughter Alinta is onto him, and is furious. He does his best to apologise, but Alinta has taken her mother's side.

Waruu is not around when Belinda arrives in The Zone, so Nerida is left to deal with her. She knows exactly who Belinda is, and is only too happy to lead her into the Hairy precinct, knowing full well the Hairies will not be happy to see her. But when it looks like they might actually harm Belinda, Nerida steps in to save her. The Hairies ignore her pleas, and it's only the intervention of Latani that saves Belinda's life. Tearfully grateful, Belinda is shocked when Latani turns on her, for being the one to film and then

broadcast her little sister's murder.

McIntyre has Waruu bound and gagged, and confronts him with the evidence of his involvement in the breakout from the Containment Centre. McIntyre offers a deal - hand over the three escapees, or Waruu will be charged with murder. Waruu turns the tables on McIntyre - reminding him he has footage of the guard's death, and the fact that he was not killed by having his heart ripped out. That was done post-mortem, by someone wanting to frame the Hairies. Does McIntyre really want that revealed to the world?

Koen is surprised when Waruu appears at the bar, demanding Koen attend to his Cleverman duties and kill the Namorodor, the beast that is tearing people's hearts out and causing such grief for the Hairies. But Koen's not interested. He thinks those Dreaming stories are for kids - just like the Tooth Fairy is. Waruu is appalled at his attitude, but Koen doesn't care. He later confides to Ash that he thinks his inheriting the Cleverman powers is a cosmic mistake. She's not so sure the cosmos makes mistakes like that.

Slade is spending time in his lab, observing his lead scientist's experiments on a human and is unmoved when the experiment goes terribly wrong. But Slade is the first to offer himself as a guinea pig when the substance they're testing is modified, and the effect is immediate and quite remarkable - he has greatly increased strength, agility and endurance. His wife, Charlotte, meanwhile, is reconsidering her decision to stop fertility treatment. She's found a new company, that promises great hope.

Excited by the success of his experiment, Slade is impatient to work with the Cleverman again, and McIntyre is dispatched to bring Koen and Kora to him, whatever it takes. But in the armed struggle a gun goes off, and it would appear both McIntyre and Ash have been killed.





EPISODE 4 LEARNING

» POWER

The lives of those not in powerful positions are seemingly dispensable as Slade is unmoved by the death of a human due to his scientific experiments. With little regard, Slade requests that the victim's family "are looked after", suggesting that emotional hardship can be eased through monetary compensation. The aim is for increased physical power, which is a valued characteristic found in all Hairies. Those in The Zone seem powerless as food delivery trucks are denied entry for two days as the authorities attempt to starve them out. Militant Hairymen Maliyan, who wants the Hairies to stand up for themselves in combat, questions Waruu's peaceful methods of protest. Araluen continues to be abused through sexist and derogatory language and physicality.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. If the government shuts down peaceful protest through

violent means, violence in retaliation is justified.

2. Human rights can be violated by governments because they are in the highest position of power.

Short answer questions

1. Define the terms: 'domination', 'exploitation' and 'violence'.
2. What are the effects of the Minister for Immigration and Border Control, Matthews, referring to a middle-aged woman as a "girl"?
3. When is it appropriate to test anything on animals? Why?
4. Waruu is abducted and held for interrogation against his will. McIntyre says to him that he would "be surprised to hear what we can do under this current legislation". When has legislation protected those in power and denied rights and freedoms of everyday citizens?
5. How are threats used to maintain power?

Essay topic

The rich will always have access to scientific means to enhance their lives. Discuss with examples to the text and examples in real life.

Classroom activity

Research the rights of an individual in your state in regards to arrest and police powers.

- What do you have the right to do if you are arrested by police?
- What rights are denied?
- How long can the police detain you for interrogation?
- Do you have the right to speak to a family member or anyone else?
- List something else interesting you found out during your research.



» IDENTITY

In *The Zone*, the humans (known as the 'Skins') and the Hairies verse each other in a basketball game. Sports are a great way to harbour a group identity and camaraderie between in times of hardship. Cultural identities are explored, though Koen dismisses Waruu's warnings as "just stories". Tension between the brothers remains high, yet as Waruu calls Koen a "disgrace" he seems to forget he too has done things to be ashamed of. Hairies who decide to shave and those who are defiant not to assimilate to mainstream society scrutinise the role of identity for many marginalised groups today.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. One must not draw attention to their own differences if they want to get along in mainstream society.
2. What someone doesn't know won't hurt them.

Short answer questions

1. What deeper implications are there for Hairies who choose to shave their hair to fit in with society?
2. On the sporting field, everyone is part of a team regardless of individual differences. Why/why not?
3. How would building a wall around The Zone effect the livelihood of those living within?
4. There are many references to "your people" and "us guys". What are the positives and negatives of an 'Us Versus Them' mentality?
5. Explain in your own words, the importance of *The Dreaming* to Australian Indigenous peoples.

Essay topic

With reference to Koen and Waruu's estranged relationship, explain why the 'nuclear family' is no longer a reality or an appropriate classification (if it ever was in the first place).

Classroom activity

Divide the class up into two distinct, but inoffensive, groups based on a difference in characteristic.

- Ask each student to individually write an account of how they feel being placed in either one of the groups.
- Do they know why they were placed in that group?
- Is their grouping based on a stereotype?
- Do they think it is fair that they have been assigned to that group?
- What luxuries do they think they will receive or miss out on as a result of being in that group?
- How do they feel about being identified as part of that group for the rest of their lives?
- How do they think being part of this group will effect their personal and professional lives in the future?



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» MEDIA INFLUENCE

Belinda appears to be protected by her role in the media as her safety is compromised within The Zone. Politics construct crime scenes to portray to the media in order to commit human rights abuses under the name of public safety. How the media plays a key role in political agenda is emphasised throughout this episode. The rights that are given to certain victims and denied to others become apparent, as Latani turns on Belinda for being responsible for filming and broadcasting her little sister's murder.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. If you're famous, you can get away with anything.
2. News reports are simply stories because the 'truth' is subjective and malleable.

Short answer questions

1. Define 'propaganda'. When has it been used in the past and present?
2. 'Massacre' is a strong word that is associated with the language of war. With reference to similar words you can think of, describe what media reports hope the desired outcome will be when they choose to use such language.
3. Do you think that news reporters should not be allowed to 'allege' crimes and supposed criminals in their reports without such criminality being proven in the justice system first? Why/why not?
4. Belinda bribes young children to give her access to all areas of The Zone. Why is this unethical reporting?
5. Belinda tells the Hairies "I can help get your message out there... I can help change peoples minds". Why is their message not out there in the first place?

Essay topic

Belinda is protected by her status when she enters The Zone. As Latani points out, "If you do kill her... get ready. She's white, she's famous, and they'll come after all of us and you know it". Discuss why both of these characteristics form a security in society and how this came to be.

Classroom activity

Explore the role of the media in broadcasting criminality.

- Why are we as a society obsessed with crime?
- List as many different television shows about crime as you can as a class.
- Discuss how much crime dictates news reportage.
- Watch an episode of the news. How many reports on crime are there compared to other stories?
- Analyse today's newspaper. How many reports on crime?
- Comment on whether reports specify different groups of people, such as race or cultures in their report. What effect does this have in promoting fear?





EPISODE 5 SYNOPSIS

A MAN OF VISION

Charlotte and Slade attend the Ilithia clinic for IVF treatment, one last attempt. Charlotte introduces herself and her husband to the doctor, unaware that it is Slade's lead scientist we've seen conducting experiments for him. Slade and Everick do not acknowledge they know each other.

Some time later, Slade and Charlotte entertain Waruu and Nerida for lunch at their sumptuous cliff top home. Charlotte reveals she is pregnant, as Slade offers Waruu money to provide housing for The Zone people. And in return, Slade wants Koen.

Koen and Blair, with Kora, return to the bar, confused there are no police in attendance. They discover a pile of ash in the shape of Ash's body, but there is no trace of McIntyre. Blair proceeds to get very drunk, and berate Koen for his affair with Ash, and his selfishness. Worried they are still in danger, Koen insists they head for The Zone. Blair reluctantly follows, only after carefully interring the ashes in an upmarket whiskey box.

Aunt Linda recognises Kora as an ancient spirit, and insists Koen send her back. But before he can do that, Waruu insists he kill the Namorrodor like he was supposed

to. Koen reluctantly agrees to try and call the Namorrodor with Waruu's help. During the ceremony, old childhood grievances flare up, and Koen realises Waruu has lured him here with the hope the Namorrodor will kill him, so the powers will pass to him. Koen leaves, abandoning Waruu.

Back in The Zone Djukara recognizes Koen and attacks him for causing his little sister's death. Despite being mortally shot, Koen can't die. Filled with guilt for Ash's death, grief that his brother wants him dead, and fear that he will never be able to fulfill the role of Cleverman, Koen despairs. Linda and Kora try to comfort him, but he's lost.

It's only when Linda forces him to perform a smoking ceremony, that Koen begins to understand that he might be the right choice for Cleverman after all.

Suspicious of Slade's motives in giving Waruu so much money, Nerida confronts Waruu but he won't tell her the price he's been asked. When she accidentally finds the footage which shows Waruu killing the guard Nerida realises she has no idea who her husband really is, and insists he keep away from her and Alinta.

Matthews, when not distracted by the charms of Araluen at the brothel, demands McIntyre recapture the escapees. McIntyre lets slip he was the one who cut the guard's heart out and framed the Hairies, and Matthews begins to understand that there are other forces and agendas at play here. Reasserting his authority, Matthews demands The Zone be emptied of people. He wants the real estate.



EPISODE 5 LEARNING

» POWER

As The Zone struggles with a lack of basic amenities, Slade uses this as an opportunity to bribe Waruu with a huge sum of money in exchange for cultural knowledge. Perhaps a tongue-in-cheek manoeuvre by the series' creators, Slade claims, "I don't care what left-wing liberals say, freehold title is the only land rights this country respects". Those in power seemingly can trade human lives with little regard for further lives being lost as mere "collateral" to the cause.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Money makes the world go 'round.
2. Everyone is replaceable.

Short answer questions

1. Why should the government ensure that every citizen receives adequate basic amenities? Does this happen in Australia? Explain.
2. What would you do if you were in Waruu's predicament? Is the potential death of his brother and loss of cultural knowledge worth the huge sum of money that may save The Zone?



3. Research 'Land Rights' and 'Native Title'. Describe what each means for Indigenous Australians in your own words.
4. Provide a scenario where you believe it to be justified that human lives are endangered.
5. List the five main priorities of both left-wing and right-wing politics.

Essay topic

The idea of "buying" a person compromises their identity. Discuss why with an analysis of three different examples.

Classroom activity

As a class, research different scenarios of where mining companies have 'negotiated' with Traditional Owners of Country throughout Australia.

- What resources are the most sought after in Australia?
- What companies are the main miners of Country?
- What countries are these companies from?
- Try and find what their Indigenous protocol is for when they have 'negotiated' with certain groups.
- Discuss whether this can ever be a fair transaction.
- What are the pros and cons of monetary compensation for these communities?
- Explain what is meant by mining companies using 'divide and rule' tactics against Indigenous communities.

» IDENTITY

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. It is acceptable in certain circumstances to have an affair.
2. Forgiveness

Short answer questions

1. How do you think a women's ability to become pregnant might affect her sense of identity and self-esteem?
2. Explain what you believe happens to the identity



of humans, like Slade, who want to develop Hairy identities.

3. List the many ways you think your multiple identities may transform over your lifetime.
4. Why do you think Waruu ridicule Koen so much for having a white mother, calling her a “slut” and a “whore”, when he was cheated on his wife with a white women himself?
5. What about Kora do you think make her an ancestral being?

Essay topic

Practicing culture is empowering for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples and crucial to anyone's sense of identity. Discuss.

Classroom activity

As a class, research and discuss the meaning of ‘colonialism’.

- In small groups read through the following article, making sure to take notes of the important facts, ready for the assigned spokesperson to report back to the class: <http://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2016/mar/17/the-politics-of-identity-and-who-gets-to-decide-who-is-and-isnt-indigenous>
- What does the author Bronwyn Carlson mean by the ‘politics of identity’?
- Why is the issue of Indigenous identity linked with colonial brutality?

» MEDIA INFLUENCE

How the media can gravely frame individuals and groups of people is illustrated as McIntyre lets it slip to Matthews that it was in fact he who cut out the Containment Authority Guard's heart. Rather than being alarmed that it was one of his own team and not a Hairy, Matthews goes about reasserting his authority by his continued efforts to empty The Zone. One would think a Minister of government would have the morals to set things right.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. It is natural to stereotype and doesn't always have to



be a negative action.

2. Media provides a platform for the coexistence of all peoples.

Short answer questions

1. Why would the Minister for Immigration and Border Control's approval rating go up 10 percentage points after the shocking image of blood painted on the wall of the jail went viral?
2. What are the objectives of protest?
3. How do you think protests can be more effective in today's society?
4. Which media outlets or forums do you think are the most reliable?
5. What stereotypes are created by the media about Hairypeople?

Essay topic

It is in the interest of media outlets to always side favourably with the government. Therefore independent reportage is a rarity.

Classroom activity

In small groups of five, spend the class researching five distinctly different articles from reputable sources regarding current Indigenous issues.

- Summarise each article, including the author, date and publication.
- Each group member briefly report to the class on one of their articles and where they found their resource.
- Here's an article to start the search: <https://overland.org.au/2016/03/the-great-australian-amnesia/>



EPISODE 6 SYNOPSIS

TERRA NULLIUS

Residents of The Zone are shocked when drones appear in the sky, announcing that all humans have 24 hours to leave. Anyone remaining after that time will be deemed a Hairy and treated accordingly. It's the only way the government can protect innocent citizens from these unprovoked, violent attacks. People begin to pack up and leave.

In the city, however, Slade and Charlotte are on a high as they listen to the impressively strong heartbeat of their child. Charlotte does have misgivings, feeling that something is not quite right, but Slade assures her all new mothers have such fears. Still worried, Charlotte goes back to the clinic for reassurance, only to discover all trace of it has gone. There is no digital trace either. Vanished.

Encouraged by the success of the smoking, Koen agrees to send Kora back to her dimension. Blair gives her the ashes to take 'somewhere beautiful'. But when it comes to finally releasing Kora, Koen hesitates, reluctant to let go of someone who has become family. He hasn't had much sense of family in his life. But Koen proceeds, and Kora is absorbed through a tree into another dimension. Taking Ash.

While Koen is going from strength to strength, Waruu is now completely estranged from his wife and daughter. When Linda confronts him about the fact that he's prepared to sacrifice his own brother, Waruu turns on her. He believes it's her fault that he's not a worthy man – after all, she's the one who drove the car that killed his (and Koen's) father, and his father's mistress – Koen's mother. He's glad his mother has cancer.

Devastated by Waruu's attack on her, a distraught Linda returns to her home and trashes everything in sight. Then drags it all downstairs and sets fire to it, wailing as she does.

Waruu heads to see Slade, but when he hears Matthews speaking about reclaiming The Zone, he despairs – what is the point of all this money Slade has given him, if Matthews is going to take the land? Slade gives Waruu a computer drive, assuring him that Matthews will have lost

his job by the end of the day.

The computer drive contains footage of Matthews in the Hairy brothel – career suicide. Waruu gives the drive to Belinda, but as she takes it they both acknowledge that they are doing exactly what Slade wants them to do. They have become his pawns. Waruu realizes there is no way out, even if he wanted one.

But Matthews does not live long enough to lose his job. Araluen kills him and escapes.

Waruu entices Koen to come to see Slade with him. In the lab, Slade shows Waruu his wonder drug – it gives the recipient Hairy-like strength and longevity. Slade is living proof of its efficacy. Waruu takes the nulla nulla and abandons Koen to Slade, who is knocked out by powerful shockwaves whilst attempting to draw blood from the young Cleverman, now comfortably in his full powers.

Back in The Zone, Maliyan makes a defiant stand against the impending arrival of the Containment forces – he will spill the first blood. A human. Blair. But before he can, he's felled by a shot. It's Waruu, who then attempts to rally The Zoners together, extolling the virtues of his plans for land ownership and housing for all.

His messianic rant is met by a stunned silence. Everyone has seen him murder Maliyan. But before anyone can move, the Namorrodor appears out of nowhere and swoops down on Linda.

Waruu grabs the nulla nulla and races to her rescue. He has dreamed of vanquishing the Namorrodor since he was a child, and he's ready for battle. But the Namorrodor easily swipes him aside.

Koen appears, having escaped from Slade – who stirs from his blackout – and picks up the nulla nulla from the ground where Waruu dropped it. He summons the full powers of the Cleverman, and conquers the Namorrodor.

Rescued from the beast, but still having to face the arrival of the troops, The Zoners prepare. Koen moves amongst them as their new leader.

And in the deep heart of The Zone, alone and bitter, Waruu doses up on Slade's wonder drug.





EPISODE 6 LEARNING

» POWER

The imagery of power is amplified in the final episode of CLEVERMAN as drones continue to terrorise the community and it is noticeably black people being stopped and checked by police in the background, rather than white. Humans are given a mere 24 hours to vacate The Zone and an eerie sense of doom threatens the fate of everyone else. The marginalised peoples appear to be used to this discrimination and hold little faith in any protection from the State, who have so willingly supported their disenfranchisement up until this point.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. The myth of terra nullius is one of the greatest lies in Australia's history.
2. Racial profiling is justified and necessary.

Short answer questions

1. Who and what are government ministers in power to protect? Explain why you do or do not think Australia has an adequate system of government.
2. When is war necessary?

3. Latani is in conflict with her human friend, Alinta, wanting her to escape The Zone while she can. She says "This isn't some bullshit political rally. This is my life. They will kill us. I don't have a choice. I can shave down, but that doesn't mean I'll feel safe. I will be scared every single day." Comment on the realities of marginalised peoples in your community. Why is it sometimes hard to understand that many people are made to feel this way everyday?
4. The Minister for Immigration and Border Control says, "Now you're beautiful. I made you" to his sex slave, Araluen. What is meant by both of these statements?
5. Describe the ways in which Waruu seems addicted to power.

Essay topic

We learn that the Containment Authority is privately owned by Slade. With reference to this, discuss the privatisation of various services to society (such as jails for instance). What are the repercussions for the society and its citizens?

Classroom activity

Slade is desperate, stating that he needs access to the Dreaming. Koen responds, "It's not yours to have".

According to Associate Professor John Bradley of Monash University, the term 'Dreaming' is 'a distinctly Indigenous Australian construction and is central to Indigenous Australian peoples social life and has a central place in constituting their lived world' (see his book *Saltwater Country*).

- Lead a class discussion about the students' understandings of Law and Dreaming for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples.
- The term 'Dreaming' is problematic for westerners to understand it's gravity, due to the English interpretations of what a 'dream' is.
- Distinguish the differences between a western and Indigenous understanding of the word 'Dreaming'.



- Read the following The Conversation article: <http://the-conversation.com/dreamtime-and-the-dreaming-who-dreamed-up-these-terms-20835>
- Read the following ABC Central Victoria article regarding language preservation: <http://www.abc.net.au/local/stories/2014/11/27/4137348.htm>
- Watch the animations preferably twice, followed by an in-depth conversation about new understandings of the Dreaming and Indigenous Law. The animations can be found either on the:
 - o Monash University website (<http://artsonline.monash.edu.au/countrylines-archive/category/animations/>) or
 - o ABC Education website (<http://splash.abc.net.au/home#!/media/1814189/the-dreamings-from-the-saltwater-country>)

» IDENTITY

Waruu is confronted by an identity crisis after believing that he was the next in line to be a Cleverman his entire life. This is compounded by his wife Nerida not knowing “who he is anymore” as he becomes increasingly withdrawn from his family and power hungry. During their confrontation his mother, Auntie Linda, says that Uncle Jimmy always saw some negative aspects to Waruu’s personality.



The flawed and racist notion of ‘natural selection’ is alluded to, while the ancestors are seen to exist in the trees, land and water.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. Naming a thing, person or place holds the ultimate power. Discuss with reference to how people, places and things are named and renamed in CLEVERMAN.
2. Weaker species are destined to ‘die out’ through the process of ‘natural selection’, leaving the ‘stronger’ species to live on. Debate with care to identify, but avoid racist arguments.

Short answer questions

1. Writer, academic, lawyer and media presenter (The Project), Waleed Aly, dedicated his 2016 Australian Gold Logie win to those with an “unpronounceable name”. Discuss what benefits there may be from having a cast of characters with non-western names on television.
2. What are the pros and cons to a change in someone’s personality. How can we distinguish between good and bad change?
3. Research Social Darwinism in relation to ‘natural selection’.
 - a. Briefly describe the theory.
 - b. How does it relate to CLEVERMAN?
 - c. Explain why you think it could be interpreted as a racist theory and a “product of it’s time”?
4. Why do you think how trees, water, land and animals are crucial to many people and cultures? Include specific examples in your answer.
5. What are Songlines? Research ‘Songlines’, in order to strengthen your interpretation of what they are.



Essay topic

There is no such thing as being “power hungry”, rather, it is healthy to have ambition. Discuss in relation to one of the following themes:

- Feminism
- Academic achievement
- Employment
- Authority
- Dreams and goals
- War
- Equal rights
- Determination

Classroom activity

As a class explore the following Indigenous map of Australia: <http://www.abc.net.au/indigenous/map/>

- Identify where the Indigenous language of Gumbaynggirr, the language spoken in CLEVERMAN, is from? Hint: it's on the East Coast.
- Discuss the sheer number of languages, social and nation groups that existed in Australia.
- Discuss how each area is a different Indigenous group's Country.
- Ask the class to compare it to the map of Europe or Africa.
- With all of this in mind, how can Australia have been considered terra nullius?
- In small groups, research how many languages and dialects were once spoken in Australia and how many are strong today.
- Why are languages extinct and continue to face extinction?
- What can we do to avoid this from happening?

» MEDIA INFLUENCE

The media is a source of valuable information for Waruu in this episode. He comes to the realisation that Slade's promises of money are futile in the face of The Zone being cleared to make way for Matthews apartments. Yet Slade still provides Waruu the means to destroy Matthews in the media: a computer drive with highly incriminating evidence to give to Belinda.

Critical discussion and/or debate topics

1. The media is a reflection of society.
2. Role models for young people exist outside of sports and the media.

Short answer questions

1. Read the following and write a response to the main points of the article: <https://overland.org.au/2016/03/the-great-australian-amnesia/>
2. How does Matthews promote the use of fear tactics in the media?
3. List the Australian media outlets that are not privately owned.
4. What do consider the most effective tactics of reportage in the media?
5. Define what you consider 'good' reporting and 'bad' reporting in the media.

Essay topic

The Australian television channel *National Indigenous Television* or *NITV* is a step forward in the direction of better coverage of Indigenous issues, Indigenous media and to providing role models to young Australians. Critically analyse *NITV*, discussing how you think it will make a difference to the industry and to Australia as a whole.

Classroom activity

Develop a Reconciliation Action Plan for your class, school and to provide to a media outlet of the class' choice.

- Go to: <http://www.reconciliation.org.au/raphub/about/> to learn more about what a Reconciliation Action Plan is.
- Discuss the most important aspects to include in the plan and the relevance to your school and community.
- How and why is a Reconciliation Action Plan important to put in place?
- Conclude with a class discussion why Reconciliation does not simply happen on one symbolic day a year, but is an ongoing process of healing.

SERIES CREDITS

KEY CAST	
Koen West	Hunter Page-Lochard
Waruu West	Rob Collins
Jarrood Slade	Iain Glen
Charlotte Cleary	Frances O'Connor
Blair Finch	Ryan Corr
Aunty Linda	Deborah Mailman
Ash Kerry	Stef Dawson
Boondee	Tony Briggs
Djukara	Tysan Towney
Latani	Rarriwuy Hick
Araluen	Tasma Walton
Jirra	Val Weldon
Uncle Jimmy	Jack Charles
Matthews	Andrew McFarlane
Belinda	Leeanna Walsman
Nerida West	Jada Alberts
Harry	Isaac Drandic
Alinta West	Tamala Shelton
Maliyan	Adam Briggs
Uncle Max	Trevor Jamieson
Kora	Alexis Lane
Jane O'Grady	Robyn Nevin
Virgil	Lynette Curran
Steve McIntyre	Marcus Graham

Executive Producer: Sally Riley

Executive Producers: Jan David Frouman,
Amelie Kienlin, Irina Ignatiev

Executive Producers: Adam Fratto, Martin Baynton

Executive Producers: Kylie du Fresne, Ben Grant, Wayne Blair

Producers: Rosemary Blight & Angela Littlejohn

Producers: Ryan Griffen & Lauren Edwards

Based on an Original Concept By Ryan Griffen

Developed by Michael Miller, Jon Bell, Ryan
Griffen, Drew Proffitt & Jonathan Gavin

Director Wayne Blair (Episodes 1,2,5,6)

Director Leah Purcell (Episodes 3,4)

Script Producer – Michael Miller

Writers Episode 1 - Michael Miller & Jon Bell

Writers Episode 2 – Michael Miller & Jon Bell

Writer Episode 3 – Michael Miller

Writer Episode 4 – Michael Miller

Writer Episode 5 – Michael Miller

Writers Episode 6 – Jane Allen & Michael Miller

Script Editor – Jane Allen

Line Producer Louisa Kors

Cinematographer Mark Wareham, ACS

Production Designer Jo Ford

Specialist Production Designer Jacob Nash

Picture Editor Simon Price

Costume Designer Emily Seresin

Hair & Makeup Designer Kath Brown

Visual Effects Producer Sharon Lark

Composer Dave Whitehead



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